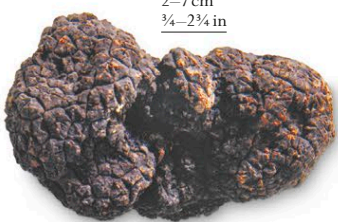


2–7 cm
¾–2¾ in

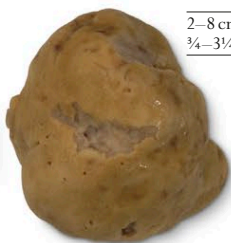


PERIGORD TRUFFLE

Tuber melanosporum
F: Tuberaceae

This highly prized truffle grows underground around oaks in the Mediterranean region. The truffles are found using dogs or pigs.

2–8 cm
¾–3¼ in



WHITE TRUFFLE

Tuber magnatum
F: Tuberaceae

Prized in Italy and France, this expensive truffle of alkaline soils in S. Europe can be cultivated on suitable host trees such as oak and poplar, by inoculation.

SUMMER TRUFFLE

Tuber aestivum
F: Tuberaceae

Found across S. and C. Europe, this highly valued truffle grows underground, near a variety of broadleaf trees.

2–5 cm/¾–2 in



SCARLET ELF CUP

Sarcoscypha austriaca
F: Sarcoscyphaceae

Found from winter to early spring on fallen branches in Eurasia and N. America, this species has a scarlet cup contrasting with its pale outer surface.

1–8 cm
¾–3¼ in



2–6 cm
¾–2¼ in

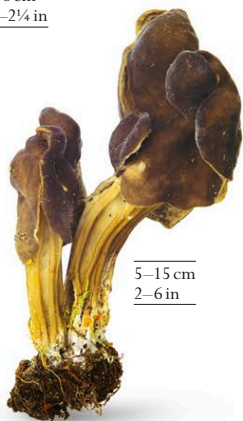


WHITE SADDLE

Helvella crispa
F: Helvellaceae

Possibly poisonous, this species is common in mixed woods in Eurasia and N. America. Its thin, saddle-like cap sits on a fragile, ribbed stem.

5–15 cm
2–6 in



ELFIN SADDLE

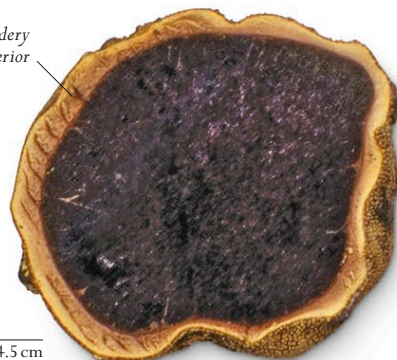
Helvella lacunosa
F: Helvellaceae

Found in mixed woods in Eurasia and N. America, this common species has a lobed, dark cap on a grey, fluted, and columned stem.

EUROTIALES

Better known for the blue and green moulds, this order includes the fungi *Penicillium* (famous for producing penicillin, the first discovered antibiotic) and *Aspergillus* (a significant cause of disease in humans).

powdery interior



1.5–4.5 cm
½–1¾ in

FALSE TRUFFLE

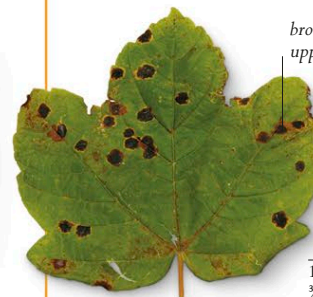
Elaphomyces granulatus
F: Elaphomycetaceae

Common in sandy soils below conifers in Eurasia and N. America, this reddish brown truffle has a roughened surface and purple-black inner spore-mass.

RHYTISMATALES

Commonly called tar spot fungi, the species in this order infect plant matter, such as leaves, twigs, bark, female conifer cones, and occasionally berries. Many species attack the needles of conifers, causing needle drop. The tar spot of maple leaves is perhaps the most frequently seen.

brown spots on upper leaf surface



1–2 cm
¾–¾ in

TAR SPOT

Rhytisma acerinum
F: Rhytismataceae

Abundant on acer or maple trees in N. America and Eurasia, this fungus causes irregular spots, with paler yellow margins, which disfigure the leaves.

2.5–5 cm
1–2 in



YELLOW FAN
Spathularia flava
F: Cudoniaceae

This common species grows in wet, mossy conifer woods of Eurasia and N. America. It has flattened, pale to darker yellow, rubbery heads.

TAPHRINALES

This order contains many plant parasites, with most species in the genus *Taphrina*. All species have two growth states: in the saprophytic state, they are yeast-like and propagate by budding; but in the parasitic state, they emerge through plant tissues, causing distorted leaves and galls.

BIRCH BESOM

Taphrina betulina
F: Taphrinaceae

Found across Eurasia, this common species causes witches' broom, a disease of birch trees that causes clumps of narrow twigs to grow at branch ends.

20–95 cm
8–37 in



PEACH LEAF CURL

Taphrina deformans
F: Taphrinaceae

This fungus infects most varieties of peach and nectarine trees in Eurasia and N. America. The affected leaves curl and crinkle, and frequently turn reddish purple.

14–40 cm
5½–16 in



red patches caused by infection

PLEOSPORALES

Typical members of this order develop their asci within a flask-like fruiting body. The asci have two wall layers: at maturity, the inner wall protrudes beyond the outer wall, ejecting the spores. Many species grow on plants; some form lichens.

dark cones



LEPTOSPHAERIA ACUTA

F: Leptosphaeriaceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this common species infects the dead stems of the stinging nettle, *Urtica dioica*. It forms tiny cones that push through the stem surface of the host in order to eject its spores.



dark, sunken spots

PEAR SCAB

Venturia pyrina
F: Venturiaceae

Found in pear orchards in Eurasia and N. America, this common parasite causes the fruit to distort, discolour, and even drop before it is ripe.

BOEREMIA HEDERICOLA

F: Didymellaceae

Found in Eurasia and N. America, this species causes circular white lesions on the leaves of the ivy plant, which turn brown and die.

